

Lesson 1 – Introduction to Life’s Purpose (1 hour)

Module: *Understanding Purpose in Life (UPL)* | Course: *Youth Impact Training Programme (YITP)*

Content Type	Text Content
Estimated Duration	60 minutes
Mandatory	Yes
Published	Yes

Learning Objectives

- Objective: Understand the concept of purpose and why it matters.

Lesson Content

Lesson 1 – Introduction to Life's Purpose (1 hour)

Key Topics

What is life's purpose?

- 7 Questions for Clarity

Difference between goals, vision, and purpose

- Understanding the hierarchy

Purpose-driven lives

- Gandhi's nonviolence, Mandela's fight for justice, Mother Teresa's compassion

Core Lesson

The Three Bricklayers Story:

During the rebuilding of St. Paul's Cathedral after a fire burned through London in 1666, an architect visited the project site and approached three bricklayers. He asked them each individually, "What are you doing?"

The first bricklayer replied, "I'm a bricklayer. I'm working hard to lay bricks to earn money so I can feed my family." The man seemed tired and wasn't as far along with his work as the others.

The second bricklayer says, "I'm a builder. I'm building the finest, strongest wall. This wall will be a foundation for this building and will protect everyone who is inside."

The third bricklayer replied with energy and a light in his eye, "I'm a cathedral builder. I'm building a great cathedral, where people can gather, pray and celebrate the Almighty."

Key Insight:

This demonstrates that everything we experience is based on our understanding of purpose and depth of vision. Everything is "an inside job." How we interpret what we do, or experience, is based on the purpose of the action and the actor, for the actor's mindset reflects on purpose.

7 Questions for Clarity

1.

What makes you feel most alive?

2.

What problem in the world gets you most emotionally charged?

3.

What are you naturally good at?

4.

What is your life's most meaningful event or experience?

5.

What would you do if you had zero fear?

6.

Who is your idol, living or dead, and why?

7.

What do you want to be your enduring legacy?

Reflection:

Answer these questions sincerely, for therein lies the discovery of your purpose.

Purpose vs Vision vs Goals

Purpose

The reason for which something is done or created. Your purpose is the reason for your being.

Vision

An act or power of anticipating which will or may come to be – giving direction for the outcome of goals and purpose.

Goals

Specific, desired outcomes that guide actions and effort towards a particular predetermined end.

Remember:

Purpose begets vision → Vision begets goals

Activities

Reflective Journaling:

"When did I feel most alive and fulfilled?" Take time to journal about these moments and what they reveal about your purpose.

Purpose-Driven Lives

Gandhi:

Left his law practice behind and focused on liberating Asia and Africa from the yokes of colonial rule through nonviolence.

Mandela:

Dedicated his life to fighting for justice and equality, transforming a nation through his unwavering commitment.

Mother Teresa:

"Help the poor while living among them, sharing their experience and treating them with kindness, compassion and empathy, but never pity."

Napoleon Hill's Insight:

Lists Definiteness of Purpose as the top attribute in ensuring achievement.